

PSALMS XCIII.—XCV.

4 (But) more than the noise of great waters, than the mighty billows of the sea, is the LORD excellent on high.

5 Thy testimonies are exceedingly steadfast: in thy house abideth holiness,* O LORD! to the utmost length of days.

PSALM XCIV.

1 ¶ O God, of vengeance,^b LORD! O God of vengeance, shine forth.

2 Lift up thyself, O Judge of the earth! bring a recompense upon the proud.

3 How long shall the wicked, O LORD—how long shall the wicked exult?

4 They sputter, they speak hard things: all the workers of wickedness boast themselves.

5 Thy people, O LORD! they crush, and thy heritage they afflict.

6 The widow and the stranger they slay, and the fatherless they murder.

7 And they say, The LORD will not see, and the God of Jacob will not take notice of it.

8 Understand, ye brutish among the people: and ye fools, when will ye become intelligent?

9 He that hath planted the ear, shall he not hear? or he that hath formed the eye, shall he not see?

10 He that admonisheth^c nations, shall he not correct? is it not he that teacheth man knowledge?^d

11 The LORD knoweth the thoughts of man, that they are nought.

12 Happy is the man whom thou admonishest, O LORD, and teachest him out of thy law:

13 That thou mayest grant him repose from the days of evil, until the pit be dug for the wicked.

14 For the LORD will not cast off his people, and his inheritance will he not forsake.

15 For unto righteousness will justice return; and it shall be followed by all the upright in heart.

16 Who will rise up for me against evil-doers? or who will stand forward for me against the workers of wickedness?

17 Unless the LORD had been a help unto me, but a little would have been wanting that my soul had dwelt in the silence of death.

18 When I said, My foot hath slipped: thy kindness, O LORD, sustained me.

19 In the multitude of my (painful) thoughts within me, thy consolations delight my soul.

20 Can there be associated with thee the throne of destructive wickedness, which frameth mischief as^e a law?

21 They band themselves together against the soul of the righteous, and innocent blood do they condemn.

22 But the LORD is become my defence, and my God, the rock of my refuge.

23 And he will bring back upon them their own injustice, and in their own wickedness will he destroy them: (yea,) he will destroy them—the LORD our God.

PSALM XCV.

1 ¶ Oh come, let us sing unto the LORD: let us shout joyfully to the rock of our salvation.

2 Let us come before his presence with thanksgiving, and shout joyfully unto him with psalms.

3 For a great God is the LORD, and a great King above all gods;

4 In whose hand are the deep places of the earth; and whose are the heights of mountains;

5 Whose is the sea, and who hath made it; and whose hands have formed the dry land.

6 Oh come, let us prostrate ourselves and

* Rashi. Redak, "holiness graceth thy house." Others, "becometh thy house."

^b Vengeance in man may be the result of malevolence, because he is subject to passion, and may punish unjustly; hence we are prohibited (Lev. xix. 18) from taking revenge on those who have injured us; but to the Omnipotent belongs properly the prerogative of vengeance; because retribution is the highest prerogative of justice, and this the more in Him who knows all secrets, and is not liable to forgetfulness, and whose very chastisement is mercy.

^c יָרַע generally means "to chastise;" and so do Aben

Ezra and Redak explain it, as having reference to great national calamities like the flood, &c.; but Jonathan renders, "is it possible that he who gave to his people the law should not chastise them when they are guilty?" and hence Philippon, generally, as in our version, "who warneth."

^d Jonathan, Mendelssohn, and others connect this part of verse 10 with verse 11: "he who teacheth man knowledge—the LORD, knoweth," &c.

^e Rashi. Others, "against the law," i. e. of God. The mischief this confederacy of the ugody do is contrary to the divine commands.